



Sunny, breezy 71/49 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 74/60 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, APRIL 11, 2026 • \$4

Artemis II crew safely back on Earth



BILL INGALLS/NASA/AP

NASA’s Orion module splashes into the Pacific Ocean on Friday evening, returning the mission’s four astronauts from their record-setting journey around the moon. During their 10 days in space, the crew traveled farther from Earth than any human has before and observed parts of the moon that no human has seen with their own eyes. **Story, A8**

Global oil shock sparks surge in consumer prices

Fastest monthly pace in four years hands Trump another political problem

BY ANDREW ACKERMAN AND ISAAC ARNSDORF

The White House on Friday received its worst inflation report of President Donald Trump’s second term, as the war in Iran sent consumer prices surging at the fastest monthly pace in four years — handing the administration a significant political problem at a moment when it has staked much of its economic credibility on

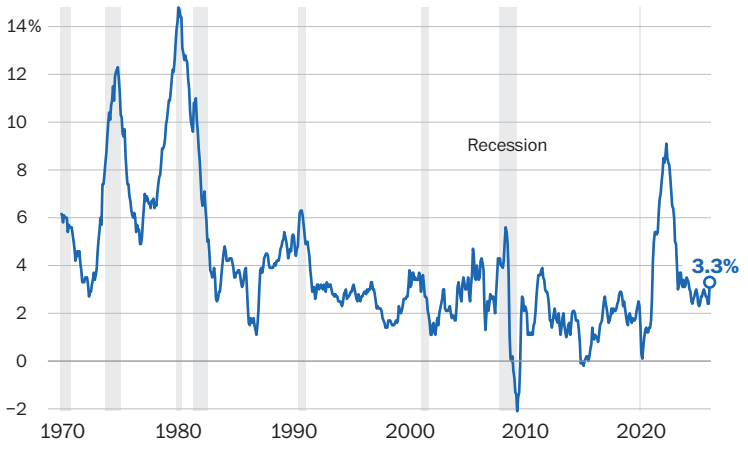
bringing costs down.

Consumer prices rose 0.9 percent in March from the month before, the Bureau of Labor Statistics reported, the biggest monthly gain since 2022. On an annual basis, prices climbed 3.3 percent, up sharply from 2.4 percent in February. Energy prices drove much of the increase, jumping roughly 11 percent — the largest monthly gain in more than two decades — with gasoline prices posting the biggest single-month spike in the history of the index.

The White House moved quickly to minimize the report. White House economic adviser Kevin Hassett said the price increases will be temporary because they

SEE **ECONOMY** ON A15

Annual inflation rate



Source: Bureau of Labor Statistics

THE WASHINGTON POST

Colo.’s legal pot market hits a harsh comedown

Oversupply, competition helped stall nation’s first legal cannabis trade

BY KARIN BRULLIARD

DENVER — Nine passengers eased into the bench seats of a small bus parked outside a sleek marijuana dispensary, chatting through the haze of the joints they had rolled. They were about to embark on a cannabis-infused tour of Denver’s murals, the kind of experience that prompted passenger Shawn Poole to leave Atlanta for this city five years ago.

“It’s why I moved here,” Poole, a 41-year-old landscaper, said of the law that put Colorado on the map as the first U.S. state to sell legal weed in 2014. “It’s just very chill.”

But Colorado’s pioneering cannabis market is now too chill for the liking of many involved in it. Five years after the pandemic cultivated a boom of stuck-at-

home tokers who drove sales to record highs, the industry is weathering a harsh comedown featuring closures of veteran dispensaries and major chains, shuttered grow facilities, tumbling sales and tanking tax revenue.

New “marijuana hospitality” ventures like Dreamy Illusions, the tour bus, are bright spots in what has become a sobering market in a state early champions hoped would become the nation’s Silicon Valley of marijuana. Its owner, Victoria Osler, says her aim is a thriving business, but also one that “contributes positively to the cannabis industry and the community as a whole.”

It is an ambitious goal. While several states are seeing declining cannabis revenue, Colorado has been buffeted by multiple headwinds. Industry experts cite competition from nearby states that have legalized recreational use, an oversupply of product, the rise of intoxicating hemp, high taxes and tight regulations that contrast with some newer entrants,

SEE **SHOPS** ON A7

Designs unveiled for president’s 250-foot D.C. arch



HARRISON DESIGN

Architectural renderings of the proposed “Triumphal Arch” were released Friday. Military veterans have sued to halt the project, saying it would alter key views of Arlington National Cemetery.

Administration begins work for formal approval of controversial structure

BY DAN DIAMOND

The Trump administration on Friday unveiled new renderings for President Donald Trump’s planned 250-foot triumphal arch, his most significant effort to remake Washington’s skyline, as officials begin the process of seeking formal approval for the controversial project.

The renderings prepared by Harrison Design feature a golden inscription reading “One Nation Under God” on the arch, which is topped with a winged Lady Liberty statue and flanked at its base by statues of four golden lions. The project is slated for Memorial Circle, a traffic roundabout near Arlington National Cemetery, which city planners have eyed for more than a century as the site of a potential monument.

The project is intended to complement the existing architecture of the area.

SEE **ARCH** ON A5

IN THE NEWS

Harris teases 2028 run The former vice president said she’s “thinking about” another bid for the presidency in one of her most explicit signals yet that she may campaign. **A5**

Maine Senate race The Democratic leader’s top recruit to unseat Republican Sen. Susan Collins has struggled to gain traction. **A4**

THE NATION

The Vatican says a cardinal’s meeting at the Pentagon was “unusual” amid rising tensions. **A3**
The fertility rate in the United States fell slightly to a historic low as teen births declined. **A4**

THE WORLD

China’s role in the U.S.-Iran ceasefire suggests that its long bid for influence may be landing. But with the truce still fragile, Beijing is leery of deeper involvement in a messy war. **A13**

THE ECONOMY

As economies in Asia and Europe reel from energy disruptions, leaders make plans to replace imported oil and gas with homegrown power production. **A14**
Stocks drifted mostly lower and oil prices slipped following a shaky Iran ceasefire. **A14**

STYLE

“The Testaments” does something far more interesting than “The Handmaid’s Tale” ever could. **B1**

SPORTS

The Nationals’ young coaching staff has made “preparation” a keyword this season, and so far it’s paying off. **B7**

THE REGION

Maryland has reached a settlement agreement with the owner and the operator of the Dali cargo ship that crashed into the Francis Scott Key Bridge two years ago. **B13**
A dance protest at the Lincoln Memorial took aim at Donald Trump and Jeffrey Epstein. **B13**

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